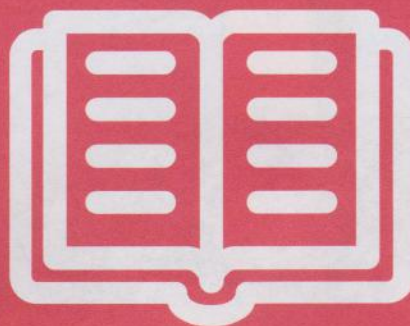


ICAS

INTRODUCTORY PAPER



2017 ENGLISH

**DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET
UNTIL INSTRUCTED.**

35 QUESTIONS

TIME ALLOWED: 40 MINUTES

STUDENT'S NAME:

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER SHEET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.

Use a pencil. Do **NOT** use a coloured pencil or a pen.

Rub out any mistakes completely.

You **MUST** record your answers on the **ANSWER SHEET**.

Mark only **ONE** answer for each question.

Your score will be the number of correct answers.

Marks are **NOT** deducted for incorrect answers.

There are **35 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS** (1–35).

Use the information provided to choose the **BEST** answer from the four possible options.

On your **ANSWER SHEET** fill in the oval that matches your answer.

Questions may sometimes be placed next to each other. Make sure you read **ACROSS** the page and answer the questions in the correct order.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.

Read the text and answer the questions that follow.

Mum, Dad, Jill, Ben and baby Tom are at the beach.



1. Who is digging in the sand?

(A) Mum

(B) Dad

(C) Jill

(D) Tom

2. What is the crab taking?

(A)

(B)

(C)

(D)



3. What is Ben pointing at?

(A)

(B)

(C)

(D)



whale



dog



sand



bucket

LOST



Name: Ted

Belongs to: Layla

Where: Layla left Ted in Sun Park, Hay Town. Ted was sitting on the park bench near the swings. He was last seen watching Layla swing really high.

When: 12 July

Appearance: Ted is a medium-sized, brown teddy bear with soft, fluffy fur. He has black eyes and a red bow around his neck.

Likes: Watching TV, giving cuddles, riding in the car

Contact: Bill (Layla's dad) on 123 456 or 123@htmail.com

Reward: \$50.00

4. Where did Layla leave Ted?
- (A) on the swings
 - (B) on the park bench
 - (C) in the car
 - (D) near the TV
5. Which word describes Ted's fur?
- (A) 'medium-sized'
 - (B) 'soft'
 - (C) 'black'
 - (D) 'red'
6. Which part of the text tells you what Ted looks like?

Read the text and answer the questions that follow.



(A) → **Name:** Ted

(B) → **Belongs to:** Layla

(C) → **Where:** Layla left Ted in Sun Park, Hay Town. Ted was sitting on the park bench near the swings. He was last seen watching Layla swing really high.

When: 12 July

(D) → **Appearance:** Ted is a medium-sized, brown teddy bear with soft, fluffy fur. He has black eyes and a red bow around his neck.

Likes: Watching TV, giving cuddles, riding in the car

Contact: Bill (Layla's dad) on 123 456 or 123@htmail.com

Reward: \$50.00

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7. What is the \$50.00 for?
- (A) calling Bill to find out about Ted
 - (B) buying another Ted for Layla
 - (C) paying to send Ted back to Bill
 - (D) finding Ted and returning him to Layla

For each question, choose the word that best completes the sentence.

Joke Time!

8. Why _____ the maths book always worried?

Because it had so many problems.

- (A) would
- (B) was
- (C) did
- (D) were

9. Where do books like to sleep?

Under _____ covers.

- (A) their
- (B) its
- (C) themselves
- (D) them



Funny Fly Facts

10. Houseflies taste their food using their feet. Can you believe that?
- (A) see
 - (B) judge
 - (C) guess
 - (D) imagine
11. Have you ever tried to swat a fly? It can be tricky because flies can fly backwards!
- (A) hit
 - (B) find
 - (C) reach
 - (D) chase



Grumpy Cat

Angus puffed up his body and bared his teeth. All four of his legs gripped the edge of the sink. It was time for his bath. Auntie was visiting us today and she does not like cats. Why? She is allergic to cat fur. So Dad thought it might help to wash Angus to get rid of any extra fur. It was clear that Angus did not think this was a good idea. Not at all. Not one bit.

Dad washed and scrubbed and brushed. Angus scratched and struggled and hissed. Afterwards Angus was dripping wet, pouting, and his tail was whipping back and forth.

‘Go and cheer Angus up, Evie,’ Dad said. So I rattled the cat biscuit box—Angus’s favourite. Angus did not look up. I put him on his favourite chair. He jumped off and padded away. I gave him his favourite toy mouse. He turned away with his tail in the air and then hid under the table.

Just then there was a knock, knock, knock at the door. It was Auntie. I rushed to let her in. She came in and sat down. Angus looked up at Auntie. She did not look at Angus. Angus looked ready to spring. Oh no, I thought, as Angus leapt onto Auntie’s lap. I bit my lip. Mum bit her lip. Dad’s eyes nearly fell out of his head. Angus looked perfectly happy. He pawed Auntie’s lap, digging his claws in. Auntie squirmed. Angus then plonked himself down and started purring. He had definitely cheered up!



12. Which underlined word is an action word?
'All four of his legs gripped the edge of the sink.'
(A) (B) (C) (D)
13. Which of these describes a sound in the text?
(A) 'scrubbed'
(B) 'knock, knock, knock'
(C) 'spring'
(D) 'Oh no'
14. Why did Mum and Evie bite their lips?
(A) They were nervous.
(B) They were pleased.
(C) They were excited.
(D) They were bored.
15. Which of these best shows that Auntie was uncomfortable?
(A) 'Angus looked up at Auntie.'
(B) 'She did not look at Angus.'
(C) 'He pawed Auntie's lap'
(D) 'Auntie squirmed.'
16. The word 'plonked' means that Angus sat down
(A) heavily.
(B) slowly.
(C) angrily.
(D) carefully.

A short (but sweet!) history of marshmallows

Who *doesn't* like marshmallows? What's not to like in those soft, powdered, chewy, little pillows of sweetness? But the next time you find yourself dropping a couple into your hot chocolate or, even better, toasting them over a crackling camp fire, think about that humble marshmallow before you pop it into your mouth. What do you actually know about it? Where did it come from?

Well, would it surprise you to know that the original main ingredient came from a plant called mallow that grew in swamps and marshes?

The healing powers of marsh mallow

Mallow is a hardy plant that is widespread in Europe and Asia. The marsh mallow plant is a variety that thrives in coastal areas and marshes and has the official name *Althaea officinalis*. The first part of its name, *Althaea*, means 'to heal'. The plant has been widely used for its medicinal and healing properties for thousands of years. The leaves, roots, flowers and fruit were all used extensively in creating potions, syrups and creams to heal skin sores and infections, sore throats and digestive disorders. It was also commonly eaten as a vegetable.



The Marsh Mallow Plant
(*Althaea officinalis*)

Marshmallows as a sweet treat

It was the Ancient Egyptians who thought of using the marsh mallow plant to make sweets. They painstakingly extracted the syrupy sap from the root of the mallow plant and mixed it with honey and nuts to create a soft, chewy sweet. It was a time-consuming process which meant that it became a delicacy only enjoyed by royalty.

French confectioners in the 1800s improved on the recipe. They whipped the sap until it was light and fluffy and added sugar to create a lighter, fluffier sweet, more like the marshmallows we enjoy today. Its popularity boomed but the extraction of the sap took a long time and marshmallows couldn't be produced quickly enough to satisfy demand. By the end of the century, the sap had been replaced with ingredients that were easier to obtain: egg white and gelatine.

In the 1900s, marshmallows were made with machines ensuring the availability of marshmallows for all. Hooray!

Stoke up the fire and let's get toasting.

17. 'Who *doesn't* like marshmallows?'
- The writer asks this question to suggest that
- (A) not many people like marshmallows.
 - (B) people eat too many marshmallows.
 - (C) marshmallows are a popular sweet.
 - (D) marshmallows have an interesting history.
18. Which underlined word in this quotation is a noun?
- 'those soft, powdered, chewy, little pillows'
- (A) (B) (C) (D)
19. The word 'widespread' means that the marsh mallow plant
- (A) is found over a large area.
 - (B) grows quickly in the correct location.
 - (C) is well-known in Europe and Asia.
 - (D) grows in swamps and marshes.
20. The words '*Althaea officinalis*' are written in *italics* to show that it is the marsh mallow plant's
- (A) translated name.
 - (B) old-fashioned name.
 - (C) scientific name.
 - (D) common name.
21. The Ancient Egyptians were the first to use the marsh mallow plant as a
- (A) lotion.
 - (B) vegetable.
 - (C) medicine.
 - (D) sweet.
22. 'it became a delicacy only enjoyed by royalty'
- In this sentence the word 'enjoyed' means that only royalty
- (A) produced marshmallows.
 - (B) ate marshmallows.
 - (C) traded marshmallows.
 - (D) improved marshmallows.
23. What happened in the 1900s that meant more people could buy marshmallows?
- (A) There was an increase in demand.
 - (B) Egg whites replaced mallow sap.
 - (C) Machines were able to make greater amounts.
 - (D) Ingredients became easier to find.

Marco and Sara

‘Down here!’ said Sara. ‘Be careful. It’s pretty slippery.’

The path was green with moss. Marco took slow steps. He kept himself steady with the tree trunks that curved over on either side. It was dark and shady and silent. Marco shivered.

‘Are we really allowed to go inside?’ he asked.

‘Of course we are,’ said Sara. ‘I’ve told you before. It’s like a museum. The castle is six hundred years old—maybe even older. I’ve been inside it hundreds of times.’

That had to be an exaggeration, but Marco didn’t say anything. He concentrated on not coming down flat on his face on the steep track.

‘Not much further,’ said Sara.

The path swung sharply and the trees fell away. Marco gasped.

There in front of them rose the huge old stone castle. It had two high towers with tiny square slits of windows and an open drawbridge leading over the water of a moat. A real moat.

‘I can’t believe it!’ he said.

It was just like something out of a film! He could almost see the knights in armour riding their proud horses across the bridge.

‘Come on,’ said Sara. ‘Let’s go in.’

Marco did not move. For a moment he stood as still as the stone of the castle walls.

‘What’s that noise?’ he asked. He pulled on his cousin’s sleeve.

‘I don’t hear anything,’ she said, shaking him off. She ran ahead towards the castle in excitement.

But Marco had heard a flapping sound coming from a low bush where the path ended. What could it be? He knelt down and peered in through the leaves. It was a little bird with bright red feathers. It looked frightened. One of its wings was hanging strangely to one side.

‘Poor little thing,’ breathed Marco.

‘Come on, Marco!’ called out Sara, impatiently. ‘What are you waiting for?’

Marco had so wanted to see the castle. But it was old and cold and from a long time ago. And the little bird in front of him was new and alive.



24. Apart from taking slow steps, how did Marco make sure he didn't slip on the mossy path?

- (A) He held Sara's hand.
- (B) He held on to the tree trunks.
- (C) He used a stick for support.
- (D) He took off his shoes.

25. Why did Sara tell Marco that she had been inside the castle 'hundreds of times'?

- (A) to reassure him that the castle was safe to enter
- (B) to show that she carefully counted every visit
- (C) to shock him with her knowledge
- (D) to emphasise how old the castle was

26. 'The path swung sharply'

The description 'swung sharply' means that the path suddenly

- (A) changed direction.
- (B) became steeper.
- (C) was uneven.
- (D) came to an end.

27. 'Marco gasped.'

The quotation shows that Marco was feeling

- (A) thankful.
- (B) proud.
- (C) impressed.
- (D) breathless.

28. Why did Marco stand 'as still as the stone of the castle walls'?

- (A) He thought he heard the knights in armour.
- (B) He was trying to remember something he had seen.
- (C) He was frightened by the water in the moat.
- (D) He had heard a noise in the nearby bushes.

29. At the end of the text, how does the writer show that Marco is not sure about what he should do?

- (A) by describing how long it took to get to the castle
- (B) by highlighting the bird's injury
- (C) by comparing the castle and the bird
- (D) by using rhyme to describe the castle



The joys of baking

Picture this. You are in a kitchen. It's cold outside, but the kitchen is warm from the heat of the oven. The windows are misted and you can't resist drawing a smiley face on the glass. Your mother opens the oven door, releasing wafts of freshly-baked biscuit aroma around the kitchen.

Baking a tray of biscuits on a cold day, or any day for that matter, is certainly a cosy experience that engages all the senses. You have measured and mixed the ingredients, rolled out the dough, cut the shapes and now the fruits of your labour are ready to taste. You pick a still-warm biscuit off the tray, snap it with a loud crack and bite into one half. The crisp sweet biscuit crumbles satisfyingly in your mouth, releasing the flavour of raspberry jam. That's all five senses deliciously satisfied! But are there other less obvious benefits of baking? The answer is a definite yes.

Baking is a social activity, bringing people together either for the making or for the eating. Who can resist a freshly baked biscuit? Baking with someone else involves communication and a pleasurable joint effort: *You can beat the eggs while I measure the flour.* It's healthy too, since you can control the types of ingredients used—*pass the organic walnuts please.* It involves mathematics and science in practice, not to mention some seriously useful life skills such as planning ahead, budgeting and purchasing.

And while you are following a recipe, you are putting your reading skills into practice. *Aunt Emily would like a copy of your recipe for your lemon syrup cake. I'll just write it down for you.* Now you've just added writing to the mixture. And what about higher-order thinking and experimentation? Why not? *I adjusted the recipe. I found if you increase the amount of lemon juice to 200 mL the cake is moister and has a delicious tang.*

But beyond the very practical benefits, there is one main advantage of home baking that hasn't been mentioned yet ...

IT'S SERIOUSLY GOOD FUN!

30. What is the main purpose of the first two paragraphs?
- (A) to describe the last time the writer made biscuits
 - (B) to persuade readers that baking is a pleasurable activity
 - (C) to list the advantages of baking at home
 - (D) to explain the best way to make biscuits at home
31. Which description uses the sense of sound?
- (A) 'on a cold day'
 - (B) 'rolled out the dough'
 - (C) 'a loud crack'
 - (D) 'a delicious tang'
32. 'The crisp sweet biscuit crumbles satisfyingly in your mouth'
- What does the word 'satisfyingly' do in the sentence?
- (A) It says what the action is.
 - (B) It gives the name of a thing.
 - (C) It describes the biscuit.
 - (D) It describes how the biscuit crumbles.
33. Which part of baking does the text focus on the **LEAST**?
- (A) how baking affects the senses
 - (B) how much fun baking is
 - (C) how many skills baking teaches
 - (D) how to bake biscuits
34. Why has the writer used *italics* in some parts of the text?
- (A) to show what she is thinking about
 - (B) to highlight specific baking terms
 - (C) to show how much fun baking can be
 - (D) to give specific examples of what she might say
35. The text is meant to be read in a _____ tone of voice.
- (A) dreamy
 - (B) playful
 - (C) polite
 - (D) bossy

ANALYSIS BY QUESTION

The following table shows the questions you answered correctly ☒ and shades the questions that you answered incorrectly ☐. The questions are ranked from hardest at the top to easiest at the bottom.

	Question content	Area assessed	Question number	Correct answer	Your answer	Students correct in AU
Difficult Questions	Interpret an argument to determine its tone	Writer's craft	35	B		19%
	Explain the purpose of italics in an argument	Writer's craft	34	D		19%
	Infer a character's feelings from his reaction in a narrative	Text comprehension	27	C		20%
	Analyse an argument to determine which point the text focuses on the least	Text comprehension	33	D		25%
	Interpret the meaning of a word from its context in a factual text: widespread	Vocabulary	19	A		31%
	Identify the meaning of a description in a narrative: swung sharply	Vocabulary	26	A		34%
	Explain the main purpose of the first two paragraphs in an argument	Writer's craft	30	B		35%
	Identify the use of italics to show a scientific name in a factual text	Syntax	20	C		36%
	Explain how the writer created a sense of uncertainty at the end of a narrative	Writer's craft	29	C		37%
	Select the evidence that shows a character's discomfort in a simple narrative	Text comprehension	15	D		43%
	Understand the function of an adverb within a description in an argument	Syntax	32	D		45%
	Interpret the meaning of a word in a factual text: enjoyed	Vocabulary	22	B		46%
	Interpret a factual text to determine the purpose for asking a question	Writer's craft	17	C		46%
	Identify a description containing the sense of sound in an argument	Text comprehension	31	C		49%
	Interpret information in a factual text to identify the cause of a phenomenon	Text comprehension	23	C		50%
	Use forward referencing to explain a character's specific action in a narrative	Text comprehension	28	D		52%
	Identify the meaning of a word in a simple narrative: plonked	Vocabulary	16	A		54%
	Identify a noun in a description in a factual text	Syntax	18	D		56%
	Explain the reason for a character's words in a narrative	Text comprehension	25	A		61%
	Identify the correct auxiliary verb to complete a question	Syntax	8	B		61%
Easy Questions	Recognise a character's actions in a narrative	Text comprehension	24	B		64%
	Locate specific information in a factual text	Text comprehension	21	D		64%
	Identify a word that describes a sound in a simple narrative	Writer's craft	13	B		67%
	Interpret the meaning of a word: believe	Vocabulary	10	D		68%
	Interpret the meaning of a word: swat	Vocabulary	11	A		71%
	Interpret a simple 'Lost' notice to determine the purpose of a reward	Text comprehension	7	D		73%
	Identify the correct pronoun to complete a sentence	Syntax	9	A		75%
	Infer characters' feelings from their actions in a simple narrative	Text comprehension	14	A		77%
	Identify a verb in a sentence from a simple narrative	Syntax	12	C		78%
	Find the adjective that describes a noun in a simple 'Lost' notice	Syntax	5	B		81%
	Identify the 'Appearance' section in a simple 'Lost' notice	Text comprehension	6	D		88%
	Locate specific information in a simple 'Lost' notice	Text comprehension	4	B		89%
	Retrieve information from an illustration and text in a simple illustrated text	Text comprehension	1	D		92%
	Match visual information in a simple illustrated text	Text comprehension	2	C		95%
	Identify what a character is pointing at in a simple illustrated text	Text comprehension	3	A		96%